

(Some) Vector & tensor algebra operations

1. Transpose

$$\text{If } \underline{\underline{T}} = T_{ij} \text{ then } T_{ji} = \underline{\underline{T}}^t \left[(\underline{\underline{T}}^t)_{ij} \text{ entry} \right]$$

Remember: flipping the indices creates a *new* tensor (“the transpose”); $T_{ij} = T_{ji}$ *only* for *symmetric* tensors!

2. Multiplication

2.1. vector/vector (dot product; row vector $\times$ column vector = scalar) – only one that commutes

$$\underline{u} \cdot \underline{v} = u_i v_i = v_i u_i = \underline{v} \cdot \underline{u}$$

Note: For $\underline{v} \cdot \underline{v} = v_i v_i$ **don’t** write v_i^2 because this expression has a free index, and it’s therefore a vector!

2.2. vector/tensor – does not commute

(**Note:** Panton puts a $\cdot$ between vectors and tensors for clarity; optional when using 1 vs. 2 underlines.)

$$\underline{v} \underline{\underline{T}} = v_i T_{ij}$$

or

$$(\underline{v} \underline{\underline{T}})_{j\text{th entry}} = \sum_{i=1}^3 T_{ij} v_i$$

but we’re allowed to (carefully!) re-index as

$$(\underline{v} \underline{\underline{T}})_{i\text{th entry}} = \sum_{j=1}^3 T_{ji} v_j$$

which **does not commute** because

$$\underline{\underline{T}} \underline{v} = v_j T_{ij}$$

or

$$(\underline{\underline{T}} \underline{v})_{i\text{th entry}} = \sum_{j=1}^3 T_{ij} v_j$$

Note: If we always write T_{ij} , then you can remember what index to put on v by whether $\underline{v}$ is in-front of $\underline{\underline{T}}$ (then i) or behind $\underline{\underline{T}}$ (then j) in the symbolic notation expression.

The following useful fact follows: $\underline{v} \underline{\underline{T}}$ is the row vector with the same entries as the column vector $\underline{\underline{T}}^t \underline{v}$.

2.3. vector/vector (dyadic product; column vector $\times$ row vector = matrix) – does not commute

$$\underline{u} \underline{v} = u_i v_j$$

does not commute because

$$\underline{v} \underline{u} = v_i u_j = u_j v_i$$

But, if we let $\underline{\underline{T}} = \underline{u} \underline{v}$, then we have shown that $\underline{v} \underline{u} = \underline{\underline{T}}^t$.

2.4. tensor/tensor (direct product; matrix-matrix product) – does not commute

$$\underline{\underline{R}} = \underline{\underline{T}} \underline{\underline{S}} \text{ or } R_{ij} = T_{ik} S_{kj} \Rightarrow \text{(for example) } T_{ik} S_{jk} = \underline{\underline{T}} \underline{\underline{S}}^t \neq \underline{\underline{R}} !$$

This is simply multiplication of matrices, where k runs over the i th row of $\underline{\underline{T}}$ and j th column of $\underline{\underline{S}}$:

$$R_{ij} = \sum_{k=1}^3 T_{ik} S_{kj}$$

“Row times column” $\Rightarrow$ inner indices (2nd one on T and 1st one on S , in index notation) must match!

2.5. tensor/tensor (double contraction; “dot product” for tensors) – does not commute

$$\underline{\underline{T}} : \underline{\underline{S}} = T_{ij} S_{ji} \Rightarrow \text{(for example) } T_{ij} S_{ij} = \underline{\underline{T}} : \underline{\underline{S}}^t \neq \underline{\underline{T}} : \underline{\underline{S}}$$

Note: If we define $R_{kl} = T_{kj} S_{jl}$ then $\text{tr}(\underline{\underline{R}}) = R_{kk} = R_{ii} = T_{ij} S_{ji}$, in other words $\underline{\underline{T}} : \underline{\underline{S}} = \text{tr}(\underline{\underline{T}} \underline{\underline{S}})$.